

SKITCH & GRIP BOODLE

EPISODE 06 —
NOTHING TO DO



7F • SUN ROOM

WATERING
THE PLANTS.
EVERY DAY,
WITHOUT
FAIL.



6F • LIBRARY

A PLACE
FOR QUIET
MINDS AND
WELL-USED
BOOKS.



5F • LAUNDRY

CLEAN
CLOTHES.
CLEAN
LIVING.
CLEAN
MIND.



4F • TEA ROOM

TEA IS
SERVED.
CALM IS
RESPECTED.



FOXGLOVE BOARDING HOUSE

A RESIDENCE
OF ORDER,
QUIET, AND
RESPECT.



3F • STUDY ROOM

FOCUS
FIRST.
RESULTS
FOLLOW.



2F • STORAGE

EVERYTHING
IN ITS PLACE.
EVERYTHING
HAS A
PLACE.



1F • KITCHEN

A CLEAN
KITCHEN IS
A KIND
KITCHEN.



B1 • WORKSHOP

REPAIR
WHAT'S
USED.
RESPECT
WHAT
LASTS.



LOBBY

HM.

EVERYTHING
IN ITS RIGHT
PLACE.

JUST AS
IT SHOULD
BE.

THE BOILER
HUMS...
SOFTER
THAN
USUAL.



THE DUMBWAITER
WAITS...
PATIENT AND
SILENT.



EVEN THE
DUST MOTES
DRIFT...
AS IF ON
RESPECTFUL
PERMISSION.



MAIL SORTED.
CUBBIES ALIGNED.
ORDER, DOWN
TO THE LAST
DETAIL.



WELCOME HOME.
PLEASE, LEAVE
THE WORLD'S
CHAOS OUTSIDE.





SOME NIGHTS,
NOTHING
HAPPENS.

NOT A FOOTSTEP.
NOT A WHISPER.
JUST...
NOTHING.



TICK.

...SQUEAK.

EVEN THE
OLD FLOORBOARDS
ARE BORED.



LEFT.



RIGHT.



HMPH.



WELL...

THIS PEACE
OFFENDS ME
PERSONALLY.

TIME TO FIX
THAT.



THE STICKY-NOTE TENANT

An illustration of an owl character, likely a detective, wearing a brown jacket covered in various colored sticky notes (orange, pink, green, yellow, purple). The owl is crouching on a dark floor in front of a door with a yellow sign that reads "7B". A small, crumpled piece of paper lies on the floor near the owl's feet. A street lamp is visible on the left, casting a warm glow.

GRIP'S
USUAL ROUNDS.

HM?

!

STRAIGHTEN.

STRAIGHTEN.

...WAIT.

THERE ARE
MORE NOW.

THAT'S NOT
RIGHT.

SOMETHING'S
OFF.

CREEEAK...

DRIP...

...TMP.

CLINK...

NOT MY
BUSINESS.

WHUFE...

RUSTLE...

WHO'S LEAVING
THESE?

WHAT DO THEY
WANT?

WINDS
OF
AKI 疾

THUD!

AND WHY
NOW?

TCHAK!

EVERYTHING
MATTERS.



BOODLE: AMATEUR
DETECTIVE.
PROFESSIONAL SNACK
ENTHUSIAST.

NOTHING TO
CHASE, NOWHERE
TO GO...

...UNTIL
MYSTERY
FINDS YOU.

... ♪
BREEZY MORNING
JAZZ HOUR...
STAY PAW-SITIVE,
EVERYONE... ♪

BUY MORE
CARROTS
(IMPORTANT)

LEFT EARLY.
BACK SOON.
— M.

DON'T FORGET
THE FLOUR!!



SNIFF
SNIFF
SNIFF

WARM...
BUTTERY...
FAINT HINT OF
HUMAN PANIC...

LEFT EARLY.
BACK SOON

THIS NOTE
IS EDIBLE.



WITNESS #1:
TOAST.

WHERE WERE
YOU WHEN THE
HUMANS LEFT?



DON'T LIE
TO ME, CRUST.
I CAN SMELL
DECEPTION.



LET'S SEE
WHAT YOU'RE
HIDING...

FLIP!



HMM...
BUTTER
DISTRIBUTION
LOOKS...
SUSPICIOUS.

TOO
EVEN.



AND THESE
CRUMBS...
WHERE DID THEY
COME FROM?

TAP
TAP
TAP

WHO WERE
YOU WITH?



I KNOW YOU
SPOKE TO THE
BUTTER KNIFE.

I KNOW WHAT
YOU DID.

**TELL
ME.**

#1
INVESTI-
GATOR



AHEM.

ATTENTION, RESIDENTS.

I HAVE BEEN MADE AWARE OF DISTURBING RUMORS.

URGENT NOTICE
POTENTIAL SQUIRREL UPRISING IN PROGRESS
REMAIN CALM. REMAIN ALERT.
—The Tenant Association



WHILE UNCONFIRMED, THE POTENTIAL THREAT TO OUR PEACE, OUR PROPERTY, AND OUR PROCEDURES...

...CANNOT BE IGNORED.

TAP.
TAP.



THEREFORE, EFFECTIVE IMMEDIATELY, THE FOLLOWING PRECAUTIONARY MEASURES ARE TO BE OBSERVED BUILDING-WIDE.

THIS IS NOT A DRILL.



WE WILL PERSEVERE THROUGH VIGILANCE.

TOGETHER.



SHOULD I WATER MY FERNS FIRST?

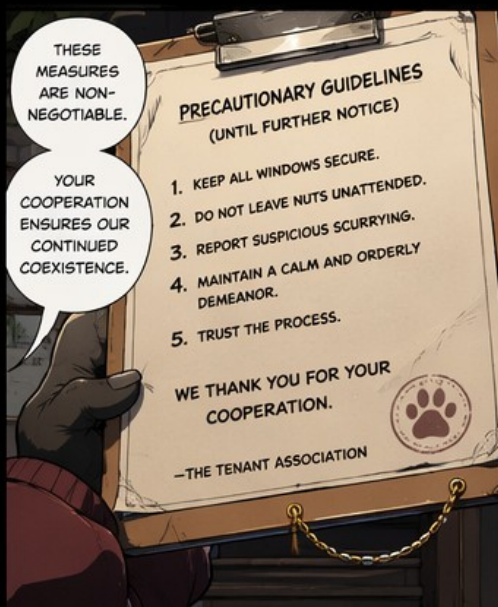
I HOPE THE DETERGENT IS SAFE.

IT'S PROBABLY JUST CIRCULAR AGAIN...

I BROUGHT EXTRA CUPS, JUST IN CASE.

MY SUCCULENTS NEED PROTECTION TOO.

IS THIS IN THE BY-LAWS?



THESE MEASURES ARE NON-NEGOTIABLE.

YOUR COOPERATION ENSURES OUR CONTINUED COEXISTENCE.

PRECAUTIONARY GUIDELINES
(UNTIL FURTHER NOTICE)

1. KEEP ALL WINDOWS SECURE.
2. DO NOT LEAVE NUTS UNATTENDED.
3. REPORT SUSPICIOUS SCURRYING.
4. MAINTAIN A CALM AND ORDERLY DEMEANOR.
5. TRUST THE PROCESS.

WE THANK YOU FOR YOUR COOPERATION.

—THE TENANT ASSOCIATION



SCURRY...

SCURRY...

CHITTER!

CHATTER!

GATHER!



REMEMBER: CALM TODAY.

SO WE DON'T PANIC TOMORROW.

...GOOD POINT.

- IN PROCEDURE WE TRUST.



DAY 2:

THE SEARCH
BECOMES
A SYSTEM.
THE SYSTEM
BECOMES
EVERYONE.

WE FOLLOW
THE CLUES.
WE CHECK
EVERY SPACE.
NO ASSUMPTIONS.
NO SPOTS
MISSED.

GRIP'S SEARCH PROTOCOL

- ☒ UNDER RUFS
- ☒ INSIDE CUPBOARDS
- ☒ BEHIND CURTAINS
- ☒ DUMINATER
- ☒ STAIR THRESHOLDS
- ☒ BROOM CLOSET
- ☒ RADIATOR / PIPES
- ☒ UP HIGH / DOWN LOW
- ☒ ASK TENANTS
- ☒ REPORT FINDINGS

TREAT IT
LIKE AN INSPECTION.
NOT A HUNT.

WE SPLIT UP.
COVER EVERY
FLOOR.
REPORT BACK.
ANYTHING
UNUSUAL.

HOLLOW
LEAF
APTS.

- BE KIND.
- KEEP IT CLEAN.
- PAY RENT.
- DON'T SUMMON
ANYTHING WEIRD.

4TH FLOOR

NOTHING
IN HERE...

UNDER
THE RUG...
NOTHING!

3RD FLOOR

CUPBOARD
CLEAR.
EVEN THE
BACK.

RADIATOR
VALVE
SECURE.
NO HIDDEN
PANELS.

STAIR
THRESHOLD
CHECKED.
OLD SCUFFS,
NOTHING
NEW.

BROOM CLOSET.

JUST
BROOMS.
AND
REGRET.

LAUNDRY
LINE CLEAR.
JUST SOCKS.
SO MANY
SOCKS.

2ND FLOOR

BEHIND
THE CURTAINS...
JUST DUST
BUNNIES.

UP HIGH...
NOTHING
BUT OLD
COOKBOOKS.

UNDER
THE BED...
SOCKS.
AGAIN.
CURSED
SOCKS.

DRAWERS
EMPTY.
EXCEPT FOR
PAPER CLIPS
AND SHAME.

1ST FLOOR

DUMBWATER
EMPTY.
BUT...
STRANGELY
COLD.

GOOD.
REPORT
EVERYTHING.
NO DETAIL
TOO SMALL.
PATTERNS
HIDE IN THE
TRIVIAL.

DID YOU
CHECK THE
WATER TANK?

WHAT ABOUT
THE ROOF
ACCESS?

MAYBE IT
WENT INTO
THE WALLS!

I HEARD A
NOISE LAST
NIGHT!

IT WAS
PROBABLY
NOTHING!

THIS BUILDING
HAS MORE SECRETS
THAN TENANTS.

METHOD...
IS TRYING ITS
BEST.
CURIOSITY
DOESN'T
NEED
PERMISSION.

THE SEARCH
CONTINUES.
AND THE BUILDING
WATCHES.

WESTVIEW
HEIGHTS
LOBBY

EVERY
DETAIL
MATTERS!

TODAY'S
THEORY:
THE PIPES
KNOW
EVERYTHING

THE
ELEVATOR
WHISPERED
TO ME!!!

I WAS
INCORRECT.

THE
RADIATORS!

IT'S
COMMUNICATING
WITH US!

FOCUS!
PEOPLE!
FOCUS!

- ☐ STRUCTURAL INTEGRITY
- ☐ SAFETY COMPLIANCE
- ☐ FIRE SYSTEMS
- ☐ ELECTRICAL
- ☐ PLUMBING
- ☐ ...SANITY CHECK?

AT LEAST
I BROUGHT
A CLIPBOARD.

UM...
EXCUSE ME.
I'M HERE TO-

YES! YES!
OBSERVE!
DOCUMENT!
FEEL THE
BUILDING!
BE ONE
OF US!

THE
BUILDING
DREAMS
IN
STEAM

I DIDN'T WALK INTO
A CONSPIRACY.

YET HERE
WE ARE.

- TRAINED
- PREPARED
- IMMEDIATELY OUTNUMBERED

THE CASE OF THE TOTALLY NOT SUSPICIOUS BUILDING

AN INSPECTION BY
DETECTIVE INSPECTOR
HOOFINGTON



I ASSURE YOU, INSPECTOR, THIS IS ALL PERFECTLY NORMAL.

MM-HMM.

CREAK...



FIRST, THE NOTE CLUSTER. AN ORGANIC ARCHIVE OF EVERY OBSERVATION, HYPOTHESIS, PERMUTATION, AND PRECAUTION EVER RECORDED SINCE THE BUILDING'S CONCEPTION.

EACH NOTE A THREAD. TOGETHER...



THE STAIRCASE. THIRTY-SEVEN STEPS. IRREGULAR WEAR PATTERNS SUGGEST MULTIPLE UNKNOWN MOVEMENT PROFILES. POSSIBLE HIDDEN TRAFFIC.

...OR SOMETHING WORSE.



THIS FLOORBOARD. SLIGHT RESONANCE DISCREPANCY. COULD INDICATE A VOID. A CACHE. A CONCEALED—

OR A TRAP.



AND THEM. THE STICKY-NOTE TENANT. UNBLINKING. UNWAVERING. DOCUMENTING EVERYTHING. EVERY SOUND. EVERY DRAFT. EVERY POSSIBLE SCENARIO.

EITHER THE MOST DEDICATED RESIDENT IN HISTORY...

...OR THE ARCHITECT OF SOMETHING FAR BEYOND OUR COMPREHENSION.



SO... TO BE CLEAR, YOUR POSITION IS THAT THERE IS NO MYSTERY.

JUST...



EXACTLY. NOTHING TO SEE. JUST A POTENTIAL WEB OF HIDDEN PATTERNS, CONCEALED SPACES, UNTRACKED MOVEMENTS, AND A TENANT WHO MAY OR MAY NOT BE RUNNING A DOCUMENTED SIMULATION OF EVENTS THAT HAVEN'T HAPPENED YET.

TOTALLY NORMAL.



WHAP!

I'M WRITING "KEEP WATCH".

AND MAYBE "EVACUATE SOMEDAY."



WASN'T ME. WASN'T ME...



THE CASE OF THE WORRYING NOTES

A MYSTERY, SOLVED.

WE FOLLOWED THE NOTES.
EVERY ONE.

SOMETHING'S
NOT RIGHT
HERE.



ALL THE WAY
TO THE SOURCE.

AND WHAT WE FOUND...

...WASN'T A CONSPIRACY.
OR A CURSE.
OR A HIDDEN MESSAGE.

I DUNNO.
IT WAS JUST...
CROOKED.

NOT
RIGHT
HERE
↙

JUST A BROOM.
OUT OF PLACE.

...THAT'S
IT?

THAT'S
IT.

RELIEF.
A LITTLE
EMBARRASSMENT.

MOVIE NIGHT
FRI 7PM
LOBBY
LOBBY

WE REALLY
WENT FULL
DETECTIVE
CLUB.

YEAH.
YEAH WE
DID.

THE BUILDING
SETTLES.

WELL...
AT LEAST
WE KNOW?

YEAH.
THAT'S...
SOMETHING.

BUT NOT
COMPLETELY.

IT REMEMBERS
THE FUSS...
EVEN AFTER
EVERYONE ELSE
HAS MOVED ON.

SOMETHING'S
NOT RIGHT
HERE.



SOME THINGS
DON'T NEED TO
BE A BIG DEAL
TO LEAVE A
SMALL MARK.

END.



